without the participation of the Arab parties. The Likud would go down from thirty-two mandates to twenty; Gantz's National Unity Party would more than double its numbers from twelve today to twenty-nine, and Lapid's "There Is a Future" would be slightly weaker, from twenty-four to twenty-one. These are extraordinary results that show ordinary electors understanding perfectly well whom they are dealing with. But how does one bring elections about? How does one bring this government down?

The results of the poll also indicate that the social resentment to which I attached much importance is less decisive than I thought. Shas would receive nine mandates and the combined list of the Religious Zionist Party and Jewish Power eleven mandates, which means that the messianic crazies are relatively marginal. Torah Judaism with six mandates keeps its low numbers and, from its viewpoint, it is right to grab all the financial advantages that it can accumulate in the present context.

The situation on Temple Mount is the immediate problem. In the last ten days of Ramadan (which start in four days), many Muslims sleep in Al-Aqsa and, in past years—including under previous Netanyahu governments—the Mount has been closed to Jews. Now, opinions are divided and Netanyahu will have to decide.

Monday, April 10

The mother of the two sisters killed three days ago died today of her wounds. A Palestinian youngster was killed near Jericho.

Thousands of settlers, ministers Smotrich, Ben-Gvir, and the other ministers of their parties, plus their Knesset members, participated in a march to the evacuated settlement Eviatar. Ben-Gvir declared: "We are not blinking, we are getting home, to the Temple Mount and to Jerusalem." The march was heavily protected by the army; soldiers were seen using force against journalists. These settlers are true fanatics and they will not give up.